

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Murali Myneni

Address: 38 Belmont Rise Cheam SM2 6EQ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to formally object to the proposed change of use from an ambulance station to a place of worship due to concerns regarding traffic generation and public safety.

The surrounding area already experiences substantial congestion, particularly during peak commuting periods. A development that is likely to attract additional vehicle movements at predictable times - including evenings and weekends - would add further pressure to an already constrained road network.

The site's proximity to a nearby school is of particular concern. Increased traffic flow, higher demand for on-street parking, and greater pedestrian activity could intensify safety risks for children, parents, and local residents, especially during school drop-off and collection times.

The existing infrastructure appears to be operating near capacity, and the application does not sufficiently demonstrate how the cumulative impacts on highway safety, site access, and parking provision would be mitigated.

Integration and Long-Term Community Impact

National policy discussions in recent years have increasingly focused on integration and the importance of shared civic identity. The Casey Review highlighted concerns in some areas about residential clustering and communities living "parallel lives." While each locality is different, planning authorities are encouraged to consider the long-term social impacts of developments that may concentrate single-faith activity in particular neighbourhoods.

In some locations, significant new religious infrastructure has coincided with noticeable demographic shifts over time. For example, parts of Morden have experienced changes in local population patterns in the decade following the establishment of a large mosque. Whether or not such changes are directly linked, they demonstrate the importance of undertaking careful impact assessment before coming to a decision.

For these reasons, I believe the proposed development would have an adverse effect on road safety and the overall wellbeing of the local community.